Higher National Diploma in Building Services Engineering / Engineering (Civil/Electrical/Mechanical) / Quantity Surveying / Food Technology / Information Technology / Technology (Agriculture) / Consumer science & Product Technology

First Year - 1st Semester examination – 2020

English for Technology I

Question 1 [Total 25 Marks]

Write an **essay** on one of the following topics at least **200 words**.

- The future of the engineering education.
- Technology in agriculture: How has technology changed farming.
- Technology and its effects on society.
- Impact of Covid 19 on human lives around the world.
- Women empowerment in Sri Lanka.

Question 2 [Total 25 Marks]

I. Read the following passage and answer the questions given below. (15 Marks)

Christmas in England

Christmas is normally the biggest festival in the English year. Once the festival lasted two days, today it seems to last almost two months. Christmas Day, December 25th, is the day when most people in Britain sit down to a special meal of roast turkey and Christmas pudding; but Christmas Day is just the high point of the "Christmas period". On Christmas day, Britain closes! For most people, Christmas is a time to relax at last after many long and busy weeks. The presents have been bought and sent, dozens of cards have been sent and received, the food is waiting to be eaten. For two days at least (if not three or four, depending on the year), the shops will be shut, and the postman will not deliver any letters. For a day or two, even the trains stop running.

In the weeks before Christmas, life is very busy. There are parties; there are trips to the cinema or the pantomime; and of course there's all the shopping. The first Christmas catalogues come through letter-boxes at the start of September! Many Christmas catalogues come from charities. Each charity has its own specialties - nature and animals from WWF, the RSPCA and others; "green" products from Greenpeace and Friends of the Earth; and hand-made articles from developing countries from charities like Oxfam and Save the Children. Big charities like these earn a lot of money from their Christmas catalogues. Nowadays, Britain's Christmas shopping season lasts almost four months! Lots of busy people like shopping online, because it is easy. All they have to do is choose from the pages of a colorful catalogue, A few days later, goods are delivered to the door..... or at least one hopes they are. Some Internet shops work 24/24 in the weeks before Christmas, to make sure that everyone gets their presents on time.

In the streets, Christmas arrives at the start of November. Santa Claus and Christmas decorations start appearing in shop windows soon after "Guy Fawkes Night" (5th November). There are no other festivities between Guy Fawkes Night and Christmas. In the streets, vendors sell Father Christmas hats, and reindeer horns! Many shops need extra staff; some shops sell as much in November and December as they do in the other 10 months of the year. Shops stay open later in the evening, and on Sundays too. During December, sometimes even earlier, the Christmas lights come on in the streets, and the big shops put on special "Christmas windows", to bring in the shoppers. As Christmas gets closer, the shops become more and more crowded. Nowadays, many shops start their "New Year Sales" before Christmas; some people therefore wait till the last days, in order to pay less for their presents.

When the shops finally close for the holiday, most people are happy that the shopping is over. For a day at least, everything is shut... except pubs and restaurants, which do a lot of business on Christmas day (though not in 2020, on account of Covid 19). In the past, most people used to go to church on Christmas morning; today some people go to church for a special Christmas service, but most stay at home to open presents and prepare the Christmas lunch. In the afternoon, it's time for more presents, or to watch a good film, or go out for a walk in the country, or in the park. Then, after Christmas, the shopping season starts again, as people spend their Christmas money and look for bargains in the New Year sales. Most people have a week's holiday between Christmas and the New Year. Some, of course, have to keep working; but for most, the last week of the year is a time to relax, enjoy more parties, and do a bit more shopping. January sometimes seems very flat and empty!

1. Mention the change that has happened over the length of time dedicated to activities related to Christmas in England?
2. According to text state two similarities in how the Christmas day is spent in England in the past and at present.
3. According to text state two differences in how the Christmas day is spent in England in the past and at present.
4. Name the month which marks the first business activities related to Christmas.
5. Mention three steps taken by business organizations to deal with the high demand during the Christmas period.
6. Mention three decisions related to Christmas shopping practices of the UK people ahead of the Christmas day.

II. Find words from those underlined that match the phrases given below. (2x5=10 Marks)

1. List of things on sale
2. To bring
3. People selling goods
4. Sold for less cost
5. Organizations collect money to help the poor

Question 3 [Total 25 Marks]

I. Fill in gaps with the correct preposition from the choices given. (15 Marks) *(on, upon, over, about, for, with, at, of, to, in, in front of, from, after, under, against)*

1. Government departments are responsible _____ their spending.
2. He is very active _____ the political movement.
3. She is very sensitive _____ weather.
4. He had an accident _____ my eyes.
5. We are afraid _____ making him angry.
6. She is nervous _____ something happening to her children.
7. Chairman agreed _____ the suggestion by the manager.
8. He will come _____ an hour.
9. Farmers are protesting _____ the new fertilizer.
10. The building is _____ construction.

II. Fill in the blanks with the appropriate article; a, an, the or zero article. (10 Marks)

1. I read _____ amazing story.
2. My brother does not eat _____ ice cream.
3. Love is such _____ beautiful thing.
4. I live in _____ apartment. _____ apartment is new.
5. I would like _____ piece of cake.
6. I was in _____ Japanese restaurant. _____ restaurant served good food.
7. Sara can play _____ guitar.

Question 4 [Total 25 Marks]

I. Complete the following sentences using an appropriate form of the verbs given. (10 Marks)

1. I _____ a wonderful film in the cinema last night. (**see**)
2. The sun _____ at 6:38 yesterday morning (**rise**)
3. They _____ to the movies only once in a while (**go**)
4. Sh! Someone _____ to our conversation (**listen**)!
5. I think Bob _____ for London this very moment. (**leave**)
6. The plane _____ off in a few minutes. (**take**)
7. This _____ an easy quiz so far (**be**).
8. They _____ in an apartment right now because they can't find a cheap house.
9. She _____ to a doctor once a year for an examination (**go**)
10. They _____ in Chicago for 20 years now (**be**).

II. Turn the following sentences into the passive voice. (15 Marks)

1. The Government is planning a new road near my house.
2. My grandfather built this house in 1943.
3. Picasso was painting Guernica at that time.
4. The cleaner has cleaned the office.

5. He had written three books before 1867.
6. John will tell you later.
7. Somebody should do the work.
8. People speak Portuguese in Brazil.
9. Everybody loves Mr Brown.
10. By this time tomorrow we will have signed the deal.

Question 5 [Total 25 Marks]

I. One of your friends wishes to start his/her higher studies in an educational institute in Sri Lanka. As a student of SLIATE, write a **letter** to persuade him/her to begin a HND course in your institute. (15 Marks)

II. Suppose you are the Manager of XYZ company. Write a **notice** to draw your employees' attention towards fulfilling their duties effectively with the frequent power failure in the country. (10 marks)